

ABSTRACT

This study examines customer perception, buying behaviour, and satisfaction towards Zudio, a fast-fashion retail brand in the Indian apparel market. The purpose of the study is to analyse how Zudio's affordable pricing, product variety, and store strategies influence consumer preferences and brand perception. A descriptive research design was adopted, using primary data collected through a structured questionnaire circulated via Google Forms among 53 respondents. Percentage analysis was used to interpret data related to demographics, shopping frequency, spending patterns, product preferences, and satisfaction levels. The findings reveal that Zudio is highly popular among young consumers, particularly female customers, due to its value-for-money positioning and trendy offerings. Overall customer satisfaction is positive, though certain operational aspects such as product durability, size availability, and billing efficiency require improvement. The study concludes that Zudio has successfully established a strong position in the value-fashion segment, and focused improvements can enhance customer satisfaction and sustain long-term growth.

INTRODUCTION

The Indian fashion retail industry is dynamic, trend-driven, and closely connected to consumer behavior. The industry reflects changing lifestyles, preferences, and purchasing patterns, making it highly relevant for academic study. Fashion retail also highlights important business aspects such as branding, pricing, supply chain management, and quick response to market trends. Its rapid growth and intense competition provide valuable insights into how retailers attract customers and sustain their market position.

Zudio is a popular Indian fast-fashion retail brand owned by Trent Ltd., a part of the Tata Group. Launched with the aim of making fashion affordable and accessible, Zudio offers a wide range of clothing, footwear, and accessories for men, women, and children. The brand focuses on trendy, everyday fashion at budget-friendly prices, which has helped it gain strong recognition among young consumers and middle-income families. Zudio stores are designed to be simple and spacious, allowing customers to browse comfortably and make quick purchasing decisions. With frequent new arrivals inspired

by current fashion trends, Zudio has expanded rapidly across India, particularly in tier-2 and tier-3 cities.

This study focuses on Zudio as it represents a successful and rapidly growing segment of organized retail in India. The brand operates in the fast-fashion market, where affordability, trend responsiveness, and customer demand play a crucial role. The present study aims to analyze customer perception, buying behaviour, and satisfaction towards Zudio in order to understand factors influencing customer preferences and brand performance in the Indian fashion retail industry.

REVIEW OF LITERATURE

Hill et al. (2007) stated that consumer preferences are dynamic and continuously influenced by demographic factors such as age, gender, income level, and social status. The study highlights the importance for retailers to understand diverse customer segments in order to meet varying expectations and satisfaction levels.

Choi et al. (2012) concluded that perceived value plays a crucial role in shaping consumer preferences. Their research showed that customers tend to be more satisfied when the price paid matches the quality and reputation of the brand.

Kotler and Keller (2016) explained that customer satisfaction is the result of a comparison between customer expectations and the actual performance of a product or service. When performance meets or exceeds expectations, customer satisfaction increases, leading to a positive brand perception.

Sweeney and Soutar (2001) identified emotional value and social value as important components of customer satisfaction. Their study suggests that consumers seek emotional connection and social acceptance through the brands they use.

Ailawadi and Keller (2004) suggested that strong brand perception builds customer trust and confidence, which in turn enhances customer satisfaction and strengthens long-term relationships.

Grewal et al. (2003) stated that competitive pricing combined with acceptable product quality increases customer satisfaction and purchase intention, particular.

OBJECTIVES

- 1.To study Zudio's business model and understand how it delivers trendy fashion at affordable prices.
- 2.To analyze customer perception and satisfaction regarding Zudio's product quality, pricing, and variety.
- 3.To examine the factors influencing consumers' preference for Zudio over other fast-fashion brands.
- 4.To evaluate Zudio's marketing and in-store strategies in attracting mass-market customers.
- 5.To assess the role of frequent product refreshes in maintaining customer interest and repeat purchases.
- 6.To identify challenges faced by Zudio in terms of competition, inventory management, and brand positioning.

STATEMENT OF PROBLEM

The Indian apparel market is highly competitive, with numerous brands offering fashionable clothing at varying price levels. Zudio has emerged as a popular value-fashion brand by providing trendy apparel at affordable prices, targeting budget-conscious consumers. However, rapid changes in fashion trends, increasing competition from both online and offline retailers, and rising consumer expectations pose significant challenges for the brand. There is a need to study whether Zudio's low-price strategy compromises product quality or customer satisfaction. Additionally, understanding consumer preferences, buying behavior, and brand perception is essential for sustaining growth. This study aims to address these issues by analyzing

Zudio's operational strategies, customer response, and market positioning. The findings will help identify strengths, weaknesses, and areas for improvement, enabling better decision-making and long-term competitiveness.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

The study was conducted using a structured questionnaire created through Google Forms to analyze customer satisfaction and perception towards Zudio. Primary data was collected from 53 respondents by circulating the questionnaire through online platforms. The questionnaire consisted of 25 well-framed questions designed to gather information on consumer preferences, shopping behaviour, brand awareness, pricing perception, product quality, store experience, and future purchase intentions. Both multiple-choice and short-answer questions were included to ensure comprehensive and reliable responses. Google Forms automatically recorded and organized the responses, ensuring accuracy in data collection. The collected data was exported to Google Sheets for further sorting, coding, and analysis. Percentage analysis was used to interpret the responses, and the results were presented through charts and tables generated using Google Forms. This systematic approach enabled effective analysis of consumer behaviour and helped draw meaningful conclusions regarding customer satisfaction and areas of improvement for Zudio.

FINDINGS

A) Data Analysis

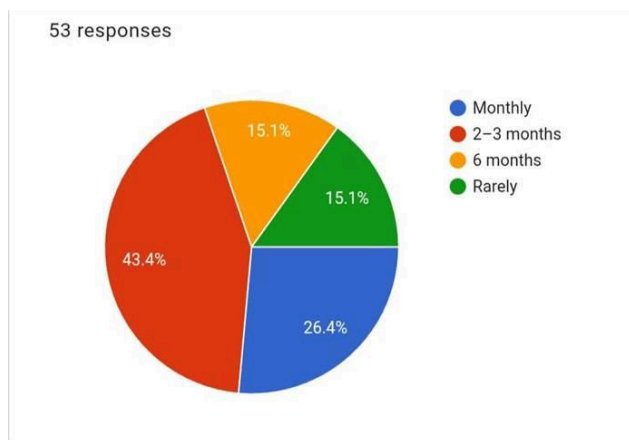
1) Demographic Profile of the respondents

Out of 53 respondents, **46 respondents (86.8%)** belong to the **18–25** age group, indicating that Zudio's customer base is heavily concentrated among young adults. Only **7 respondents (13.2%)** fall outside this age group, showing limited engagement from older customers.

In terms of gender, **44 respondents (83%) are female** and **9 respondents (17%) are male**, indicating stronger participation and engagement from female customers. This distribution implies that Zudio's pricing, product range, and fashion appeal are currently best aligned with young female consumers, while there is scope to increase reach among male and older customer segments.

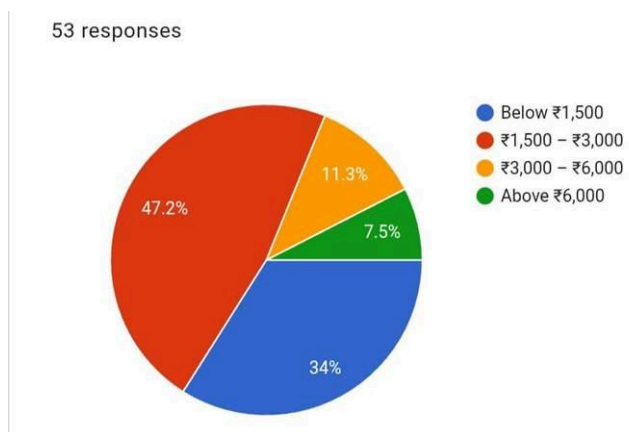
2) Buying Behaviour of the Customers

2.1: Shopping Frequency of Customers



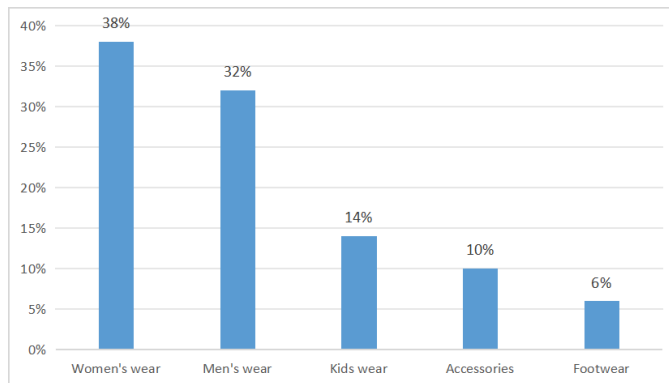
A majority of respondents (43.4%) shop once every 2–3 months, indicating a moderate purchasing pattern. About 26.4% of customers shop monthly, while 15.1% shop once every six months and another 15.1% shop rarely.

2.2 Average Budget per Purchase



It is observed that 47.2% of respondents spend between ₹1,500 and ₹3,000 per purchase, followed by 34% who spend below ₹1,500. A smaller proportion of customers spend between ₹3,000 and ₹6,000 (11.3%), while only 7.5% spend above ₹6,000

3) Product and Shopping Preferences

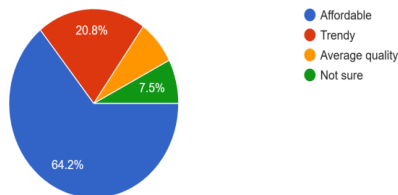


The bar graph shows that **women's wear (38%)** is the most preferred product category, followed by **men's wear (32%)**. **Kids wear (14%)**, **accessories (10%)**, and **footwear (6%)** have comparatively lower preference among customers.

4) Customer Perception of Zudio as a Brand

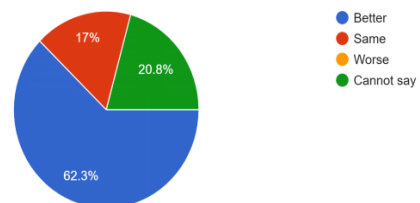
4.1

53 responses



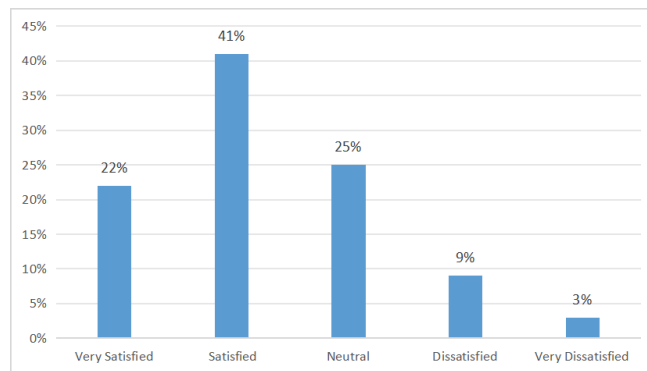
4.2

53 responses



The graphs show that **64.2%** of respondents perceive Zudio as an **affordable** brand, while **20.8%** consider it **trendy**. When compared to similar brands, **62.3%** rate Zudio as **better**, indicating a generally positive customer perception.

5) Level of Customer Satisfaction and Product Evaluation



The bar graph indicates that **41%** of customers are **satisfied** and **22%** are **very satisfied**, showing overall positive satisfaction levels. **25%** of respondents are **neutral**, while a smaller proportion are **dissatisfied (9%)** or **very dissatisfied (3%)**, suggesting limited negative feedback.

6) Store Experience and Customer Loyalty

Chart 6.1

53 responses

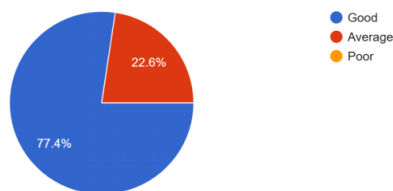
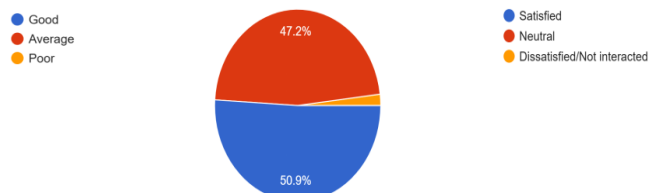


Chart 6.2

53 responses



The charts show that **77.4%** of respondents rate Zudio's overall store environment as **good**, while **22.6%** consider it **average**. In terms of staff assistance, **50.9%** of customers are **satisfied**, **47.2%** feel **neutral**, and only a very small percentage report dissatisfaction or no interaction, indicating a generally positive in-store experience.

B) Findings

1. The majority of respondents belong to the young adult age group, indicating that Zudio strongly appeals to younger consumers.
2. Female customers form a larger portion of the customer base, with women's wear emerging as the most preferred product category.
3. The brand also attracts a considerable number of male customers, showing that its appeal extends beyond a single gender segment.
4. Customers generally shop at Zudio monthly or occasionally, suggesting that purchases are steady but need-based rather than frequent.
5. Most respondents prefer shopping within a lower budget range, highlighting Zudio's strong positioning as an affordable fashion brand.
6. Price sensitivity is high among customers, with affordability influencing purchase decisions more than premium quality.
7. Zudio is largely perceived as a trendy and value-for-money brand and is viewed positively when compared to similar fashion retailers.
8. Customer satisfaction with product quality is neutral to positive, indicating acceptable quality at the price offered.
9. The store environment is rated positively by most respondents, contributing to a comfortable shopping experience.
10. Billing efficiency, crowd management, and product size availability were identified as key areas requiring improvement.
11. Most customers expressed willingness to shop at Zudio again and recommend the brand to others, indicating moderate to high customer loyalty.

Suggestions

1. Zudio should improve product quality, especially in non-cotton clothing and footwear, as several customers expressed concerns about durability.
2. The brand should introduce a wider variety of designs and more exclusive collections to reduce repetition and increase customer interest.

3. Expanding size options, including plus-size collections, would help Zudio cater to a broader customer base and improve inclusivity.
4. Billing counters should be managed more efficiently during peak hours to reduce waiting time and improve the checkout experience.
5. Better inventory and stock management is required to ensure consistent availability of popular products and sizes.
6. Improving store ambience through better music, layout organization, and crowd management can enhance the overall shopping experience.

Conclusion

The study concludes that Zudio has effectively positioned itself as a leading affordable fast-fashion brand in the Indian retail market by catering to the needs of price-sensitive and trend-conscious consumers. The overall findings indicate a positive customer perception, with affordability, product variety, and store ambience serving as key strengths. Zudio's strong appeal among young and female customers highlights its success in the mass-market segment, while the presence of male shoppers suggests opportunities for further expansion. Although customer satisfaction levels are largely neutral to positive, challenges related to product quality consistency, limited size options, billing delays, and crowd management were identified. Addressing these issues can significantly improve the overall shopping experience and encourage repeat purchases. The study recommends enhancing product durability, expanding size inclusivity, improving inventory control, and streamlining checkout processes. Overall, Zudio's value-for-money approach remains its core advantage, and strategic improvements will help maintain customer loyalty and competitive positioning in the evolving fashion retail industry.